BRAND LAUNCH / PROPOSED EXECUTION

FROM WORK DONE TO PUBLIC LAUNCH

Whitetail Syndicate

The website is built and available for review. The product catalog has been audited, the approval tools are ready, and conversations with hunters and organizations have already started. Here is the path from that work to launch.



Existing Whitetail artwork supplied within the working story materials. Not a newly commissioned logo.

PURPOSE OF THE MEETING

Show what already exists, decide what actually represents the brand, finish the store correctly, and give the people responding to our outreach a public destination we are comfortable putting our name on.

FIRST STEP

Review the website I deployed through GitHub Pages and the Horizon theme already installed in Shopify as unpublished. I want to walk through the actual site with you, record specific edits, agree on featured products, and test the staged Shopify theme before requesting approval to publish.

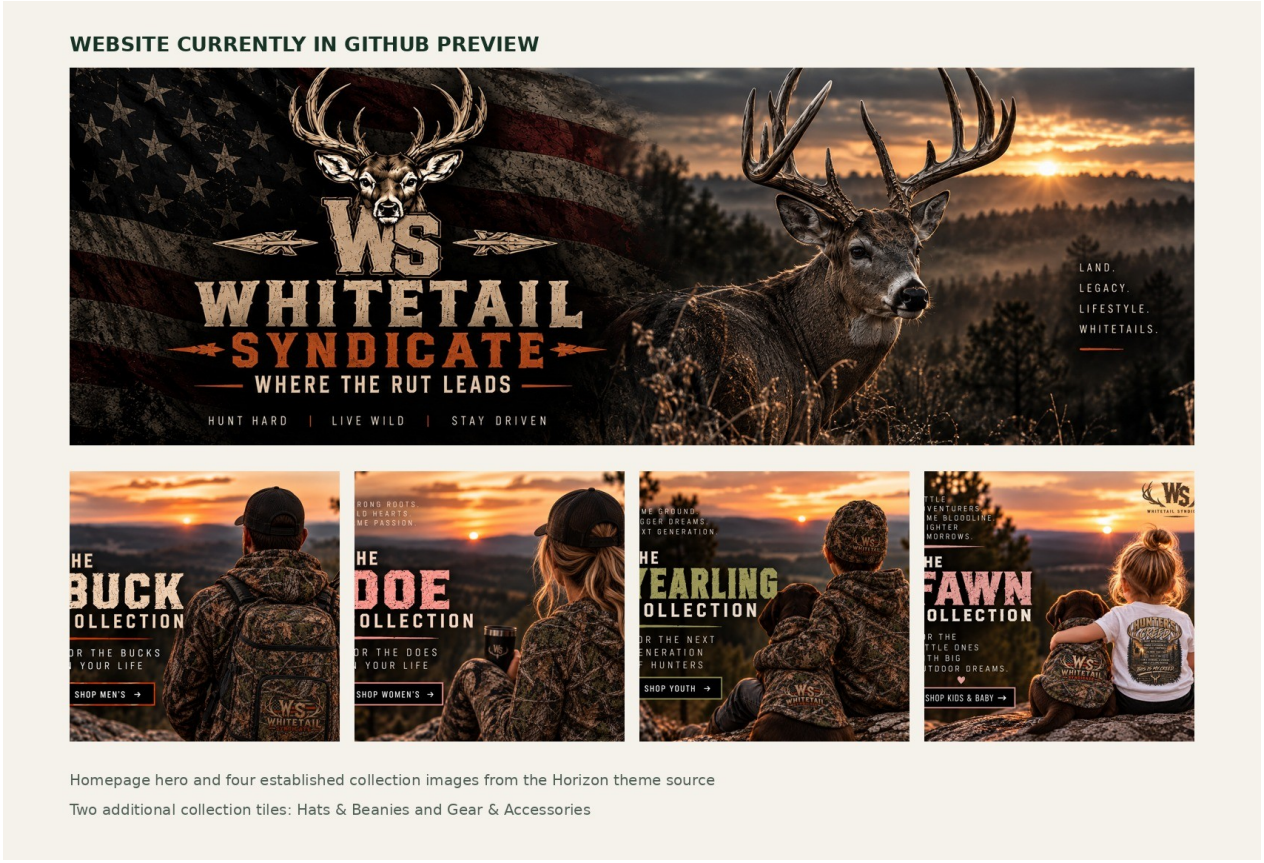
Prepared by Craig Ramos for Kraig and Lori | October 8, 2026

01 The website is built and ready to review

The revised Whitetail Syndicate website is available to review on GitHub Pages, and its Horizon theme is already installed in Shopify as an unpublished theme. This gives us both a browser-accessible presentation and a staged Shopify version for owner review. I want your feedback on the appearance, collections, product presentation, stories, and overall direction before anything replaces the current published storefront.

OPEN THE WEBSITE

https://craigcoda.github.io/whitetail-syndicate-horizon/



Current Horizon hero and established collection images used by the GitHub Pages preview. Open the URL above to review the full page and navigation.

WHAT THE DEPLOYED PREVIEW ALREADY PRESENTS

- Branded homepage with the revised hero and a clear connection between the collections, shopping and hunter stories.
- Buck, Doe, Yearling and Fawn collection artwork, plus Hats & Beanies and Gear & Accessories tiles.
- View-only collection and individual-product pages populated from a stored Shopify catalog snapshot.
- Nathan Deville's "Wait Till He Turns" story thumbnail and linked branded story page.
- "Become part of the story" inquiry layout, community signup, and Rut Line Coming Soon notification presentation.

Decision I need. Please approve the visual direction or give me the changes you want. The theme is already installed in Shopify as unpublished; I can apply approved revisions there and complete its acceptance tests.

The decisions in front of us

The redesigned website is available to review now, and the Horizon theme is already staged in Shopify as unpublished. My recommendation is to review this completed work, decide which products will represent us, finish the Shopify acceptance and commerce checks, and then introduce the approved brand through relationships already underway.

FOUR CONNECTED OUTCOMES

Area	Already in hand	What must happen next
PRODUCTS	Catalog audits, product images, review tool and live-data snapshot.	Owner selects the launch range; supplier, samples, price and fulfillment facts checked.
WEBSITE	Revised website deployed on GitHub Pages, browsing and story presentation in place, and Horizon theme installed in Shopify as unpublished.	Review GitHub and staged Shopify site; approve changes, complete functional testing, then authorize publication.
RELATIONSHIPS	Research, personalized emails, referrals, replies and phone invitations.	Respond based on what each person asked; no unfinished website sent as a finished brand.
ORIGINAL STORIES	Hunter interview workflow and Nathan story treatment in branded HTML.	Verify facts, obtain permissions, and publish approved written story; pilot film separately approved.

Operating rule

The first impression we send to a hunter, donor program, guide, or prospective partner should match the work we are describing. Website approval comes before broad promotion. A reply is not a license to use a story. A product title is not proof that the fulfillment route is correct.

Presentation order

- Show the existing evidence, not mock promises.
- Confirm which products and imagery will represent us.
- Open the GitHub-deployed website together and record any specific changes.
- Review the actual outreach responses and proposed conversations.
- Approve or decline the first story publication and a separate documentary pilot.
- Agree on who makes decisions and how we know we are ready to go live.

02 Store and products: work already completed

Read-only storefront and catalog investigation | Sep 30–Oct 1 | DONE / LOCAL WORK

Reviewed the customer-facing product catalog, collections, titles, pricing, artwork, and shopping path. The October 1 reference includes 108 product records, 1,265 variants and 46 recorded findings.

Why it matters. The issues have a documented starting point. We can approve corrections rather than change products blindly.

EVIDENCE P01 October 1 audit HTML

Duplicate and collection-placement checks | Oct 1–3 | DONE / LOCAL WORK

A separate October 3 review recorded 113 entries and 25 repeated-title groups covering 61 listings. It also highlighted menswear in Doe and a duffle appearing in youth-oriented collections.

Why it matters. Similar titles need review, not automatic merges. Brand taxonomy and supplier mappings both affect the solution.

EVIDENCE P02 October 3 audit PDF

Actual shopping-path sample | Oct 3 | DONE / LOCAL WORK

Checked a beanie size M through cart and into checkout, then removed the test item. No payment or order was submitted. Shipping, tax and fulfillment were not verified.

Why it matters. A basic product-choice flow worked once, but this does not establish commercial readiness.

EVIDENCE P02 Audit purchase-path section

Real product-image references and design review | Oct 4–8 | DONE / LOCAL WORK

Gathered actual store-product sources and worked through collection graphics to distinguish existing merchandise from invented apparel graphics. Retained unsuccessful or superseded versions as revision history.

Why it matters. The final images can now be verified against actual catalog records rather than treated as artistic guesses.

EVIDENCE P03 Product source HTML and ZIPs

02 Store and products: a decision system exists

Fresh Shopify inventory snapshot | Oct 6 | DONE / LOCAL WORK

Captured a read-only baseline of 125 active products, 1,722 variants and eight collections. The stored comparison identifies 18 handles not in the earlier audit and one historical handle not present in the newer snapshot.

Why it matters. Product decisions can be based on dated records, with current-state facts kept separate from earlier observations.

EVIDENCE P04 Product Control / snapshot-meta.json

Whitetail Product Control application | Oct 6 | DONE / LOCAL WORK

Developed a local, offline-first catalog review tool with product flags, design/duplicate review, action queues, launch gates and structured exports. The archived project contains source code, a build and test files. Tests were not rerun for this new document.

Why it matters. The owner can choose changes without giving the review tool permission to edit the live store.

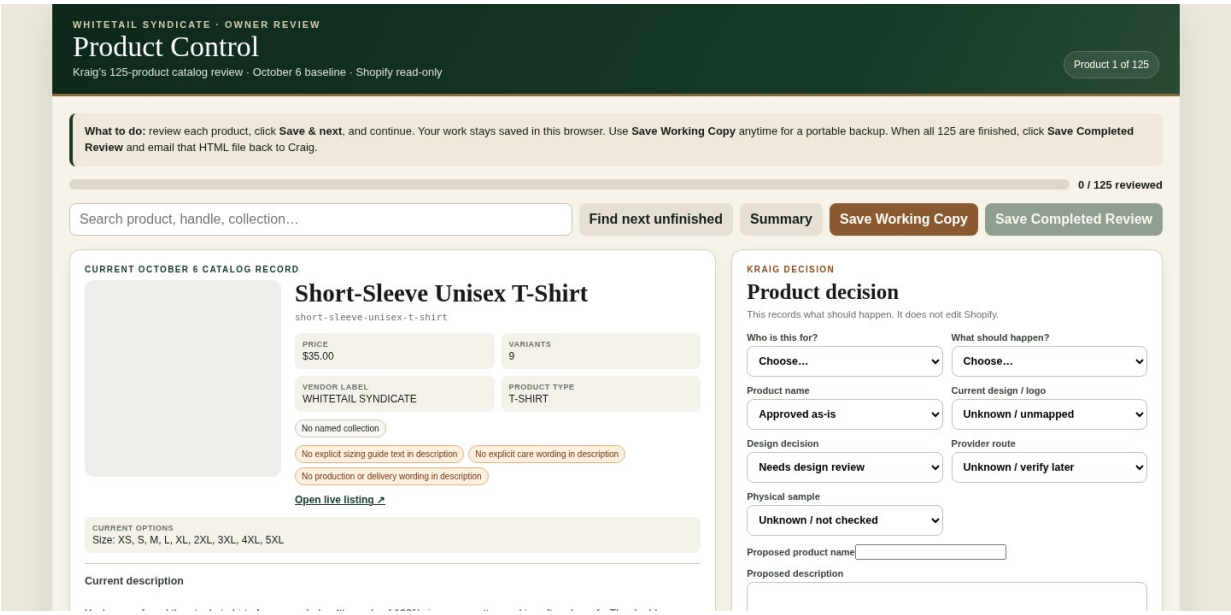
EVIDENCE P04 Product Control application ZIP

Kraig-facing product review | Oct 7 | DONE / LOCAL WORK

Prepared a single-file, browser-based owner review of the 125-product snapshot. It presents the current listing beside decisions on placement, product status, design, descriptions and provider verification.

Why it matters. This turns general instructions into specific, reviewable decisions that can be handed back for controlled execution.

EVIDENCE P05 Kraig Product Review HTML



Actual local owner-review interface, captured from the October 7 HTML artifact. No owner decisions or live Shopify changes are implied.

03 Store and products: the launch path

The goal is not to make all 125 records perfect before anything can happen. It is to agree on a manageable first assortment that we can prove is accurate and fulfillable, while documenting what should be hidden, repaired or held back.

Stage 1 | Approve the first merchandise group

Work to complete. Kraig and Lori select the initial five design families and actual garments. For each, record exact artwork version, sizes, colors, audience, product handle and intended collection.

Exit condition. A named, owner-approved launch list. No vague “these look good” approvals.

DECISION / RESPONSIBILITY **Kraig approves; Lori supplies production context; Craig records**

Stage 2 | Verify the suppliers and samples

Work to complete. For every selected product/variant, confirm supplier ID, fulfillment route, printing, placement, actual costs, shipping, fit information and sample status.

Exit condition. No selected item depends on a guessed vendor label or unverified garment.

DECISION / RESPONSIBILITY **Supplier/owners verify; Craig documents**

Stage 3 | Prepare the exact catalog change list

Work to complete. Use Product Control to mark keep, repair, move, variant-review, hold or retire. Investigate duplicates with SKU and fulfillment facts; protect links and existing orders.

Exit condition. One prioritized, reversible, owner-approved change queue.

DECISION / RESPONSIBILITY **Kraig decides; Craig stages execution**

Stage 4 | Prove the shopping experience

Work to complete. Check product pages, size charts, policies, cart, taxes, shipping, order routing, customer emails and the actual provider handoff. Any test purchase requires scope and spending authorization.

Exit condition. An owner-accepted commerce test, not merely a working Add to Cart button.

DECISION / RESPONSIBILITY **Owners authorize; Craig coordinates checks**

OPEN ISSUES IDENTIFIED IN THE EXISTING EVIDENCE

- Repeated titles and potentially duplicated listings; confirm each product and supplier relationship first.
- Misplaced products in Doe, Yearling or Fawn.
- Supplier-style titles, missing sizing/delivery explanations and incomplete storefront policies.
- Rut Line is not an available scent product assortment and should not show an empty shopping grid.

04 Website: what has actually been built

Horizon source recovery and protected local work | Sep 30–Oct 3 | DONE / LOCAL WORK

Recovered and inspected the theme source, Liquid sections, JSON templates, CSS and asset organization. Worked on separate local archives instead of changing the current published Shopify theme.

Why it matters. There is a technical candidate to review and a preserved original for comparison and rollback.

EVIDENCE W01 Original/revised Horizon ZIPs

Brand sections, shop links and content corrections | Oct 3 | DONE / LOCAL WORK

Built local approaches for more readable navigation and collection presentation, a truthful Our Story direction, removal of false video-play imagery and generic social targets, and a Rut Line scents Coming Soon view.

Why it matters. These address observed customer confusion without claiming content or video that does not yet exist.

EVIDENCE W02 Local-build audit, sections F01–F13

Code and archive checks | Oct 3 | DONE / LOCAL WORK

Recorded validation of JSON/Liquid schemas and existing JavaScript, zero new Theme Check issues, and ZIP/source integrity. Runtime tests of the final revised storefront remained outside that validation.

Why it matters. The work has a tested code foundation, but visual and checkout acceptance still need actual Shopify testing.

EVIDENCE W02 Local-build audit, test register

Collection artwork and layout iterations | Oct 4–8 | DONE / LOCAL WORK

Worked on Buck, Doe, Yearling, Fawn, Hats & Beanies and Gear & Accessories, including superseded or rejected images. The retained instruction is to preserve the original four collection presentation and add two appropriate tiles.

Why it matters. The revision history remains visible, but final approval applies only to the chosen images and page behavior.

EVIDENCE W03 Theme previews, imagery archive, GitHub revisions

04 Website: the deployed review site

The website is already available as a complete browser-based review, with the established visual design and additional product, story and interest sections working together. It is the main deliverable I am bringing for approval.

REVIEW URL

https://craigcoda.github.io/whitetail-syndicate-horizon/

Collection navigation and product browsing | Oct 7–8 | DEPLOYED FOR REVIEW

The GitHub Pages branch contains an actual index.html, separate collection.html and product.html pages, preview.css/preview.js, and a view-only preview-catalog.json sourced from Whitetail product records. Collection navigation covers Buck, Doe, Yearling, Fawn, Hats & Beanies and Gear & Accessories.

Why it matters. The review site shows the structure and catalog presentation rather than only a static homepage image.

EVIDENCE W04 gh-pages index.html, collection.html, product.html and preview-catalog.json

Hunter story and outreach intake presentation | Oct 7–8 | DEPLOYED FOR REVIEW

The deployed homepage includes the Every Hunt Has a Story section, a link to Nathan Deville's branded feature, a Become part of the story inquiry layout, a general community signup layout, and a Rut Line notification section.

Why it matters. It connects the apparel to the real stories and relationships already underway, which is the brand direction I want approved.

EVIDENCE W04 gh-pages index.html and story.html

Horizon theme installed in Shopify as unpublished | Oct 7–8 | STAGED / AWAITING OWNER REVIEW

The main GitHub repository branch contains the Horizon Liquid, JSON, layout, section, and asset source. The gh-pages branch serves the browser review site. The Horizon theme has also been installed in Shopify as an unpublished theme. Next, we need to confirm the staged Shopify copy reflects the approved website and passes its functional checks.

Why it matters. The design can be reviewed both on GitHub Pages and in the already staged Shopify theme, before any change to the published storefront.

EVIDENCE W04 GitHub main branch and README

WHAT I NEED FROM THIS WEBSITE REVIEW

- Approval or specific edits to the homepage, collection cards and typography.
- Confirmation that the featured merchandise and collection links are the correct ones.
- Approval of the story presentation, inquiry wording and Rut Line Coming Soon presentation.
- Approval to test the existing unpublished Shopify theme, verify that it matches the accepted design, and keep the live theme unchanged until final signoff.

05 Website: the approval and release path

Open the GitHub Pages website and the existing unpublished Shopify theme together. I will record changes you request, apply approved revisions to the staged theme, and test it in Shopify before requesting permission to make it the published storefront.

Check	Review question	Required proof before publication
Home and identity	Does this look and read like Whitetail Syndicate?	Approved logo, typography, copy and selected imagery.
Six shop collections	Are Buck, Doe, Yearling, Fawn, Hats and Gear shown correctly?	Confirmed products, links, images and category mapping.
Rut Line	Does it clearly say scents Coming Soon?	No false stock, unsupported performance claims or empty catalog errors.
Our Story / hunters	Can visitors understand and contact the brand?	Accurate routes; only consented stories and images.
Shopping	Can a customer buy what is featured?	Variant, cart, shipping, tax, order/provider and customer-email checks.
Mobile / access	Can it be used on a phone?	360–390px plus tablet/desktop review, keyboard checks and readable text.
Rollback	What if the new theme breaks something?	Original theme retained and a named restore method.

PUBLISH GATE

First: review the deployed GitHub Pages website and the unpublished Shopify theme. Second: agree on any corrections and confirm both represent the intended design. Third: test product links, forms, mobile layout, cart, checkout, and customer communications using the staged Shopify theme. Fourth: obtain explicit approval to publish. Fifth: verify the public storefront after the approved switch.

NOT APPROVED AUTOMATICALLY

Changes to product prices, catalog records, checkout policies, mailing lists, third-party subscriptions, paid advertising or public story rights are separate decisions.

06 Relationships: what is already real

Prospect research with a story-specific reason | Oct 5–8 | DONE / LOCAL WORK

Identified guides, hunting clubs, nonprofit programs, youth mentors, veteran groups, public agencies, bowhunters, processors, deer recovery operators and outdoor media where a genuine account might be worth telling.

Why it matters. The outreach is aimed at people with a relevant experience, not generic traffic bought for the store.

EVIDENCE O01 Prospect and outreach records

Personalized invitations and form contact | Oct 5–8 | DONE / LOCAL WORK

Gmail checks recovered at least 99 first-contact emails by the early October 8 cut. A later archive recorded 101 sent outreach messages in its own snapshot. Website forms and mail follow-ups are tracked separately.

Why it matters. The brand already has external awareness and conversations underway before a public promotional launch.

EVIDENCE O01 Sent-mail archive / individual Gmail threads

Real responses and possible introductions | Oct 5–8 | DONE / LOCAL WORK

The retained outreach record showed 25 organizations with human replies and 27 associated reply messages at that checkpoint. Some offered phone calls or introductions; others requested a website example, purpose, print/multimedia format or approval process.

Why it matters. There is a relationship pipeline to manage. Interest is not a booked interview or consent to publish.

EVIDENCE O02 Reply summaries and correspondence

Reply plan and owner-facing coordination | Oct 7–8 | DONE / LOCAL WORK

Sorted contacts by call readiness, clarification needed, referral, organizational authorization and waiting for a site example. Produced a Kraig review brief and sent selective follow-ups.

Why it matters. We can work from what each person actually asked rather than send an unfinished URL to everyone.

EVIDENCE O03 Responses and Call Plan; Gmail follow-ups

THREE EXAMPLES WORTH SHOWING IN THE MEETING

Contact	What they actually offered or requested	Next safe action
Greg Ray / Outdoor Solutions	Potential parent-child introduction; asked how/where the article would appear and who would see it.	Answer format and approval process; hold public site link until ready.
Lea White / Arkansas BOW	Knew women who might be interested and invited discussion.	Agree a call and explain permissions before introductions.
Pete Eisentrager / Missouri Disabled Sportsmen	Offered a phone discussion about Timmy's memorial hunt.	Confirm a call agenda and scheduling preference.

07 Stories: the first publishable model

Interview and consent workflow | Oct 2–6 | DONE / LOCAL WORK

Prepared live interview prompts, narrative follow-up questions and draft recording/story-sharing preferences, including parent/guardian and location-permission considerations.

Why it matters. Story development can follow an actual process rather than rely on unstructured conversations.

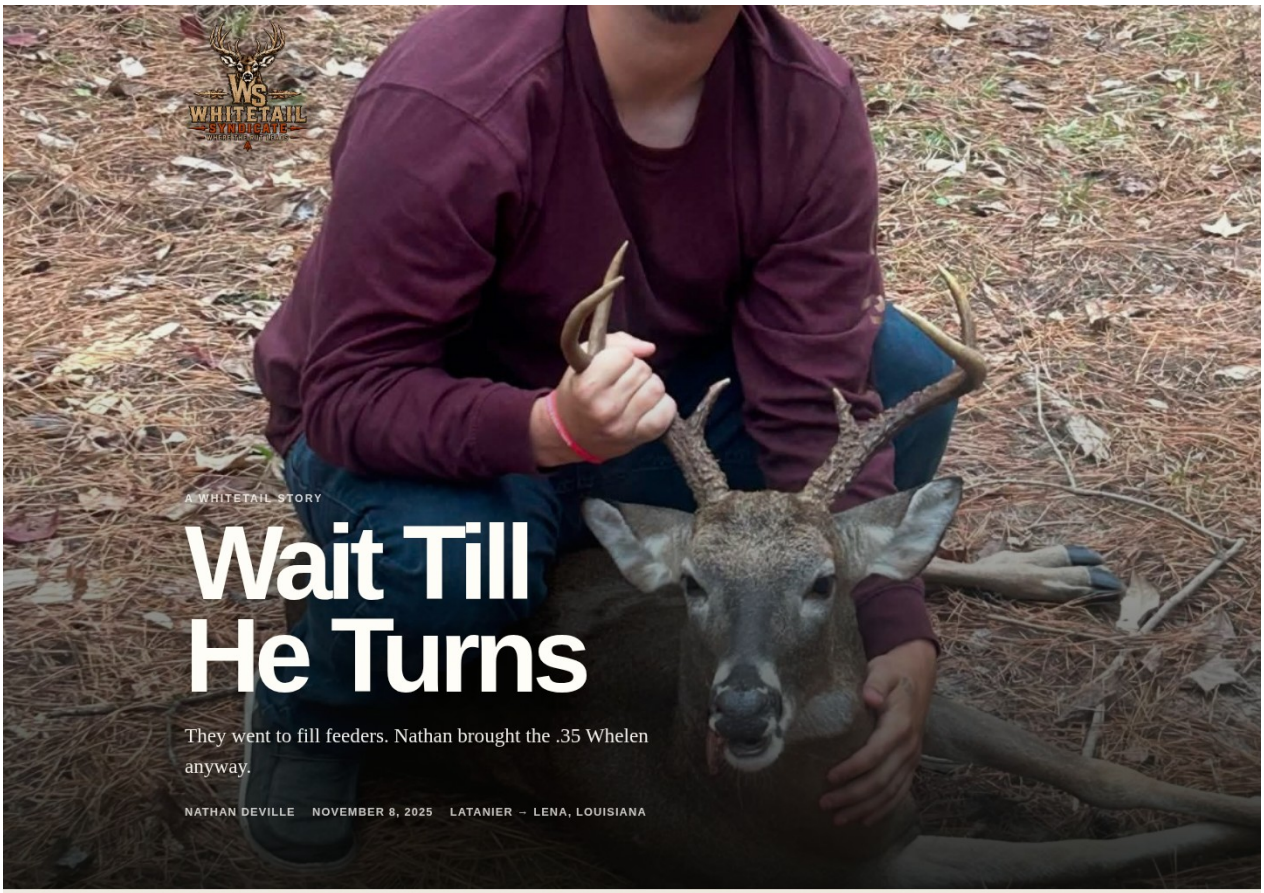
EVIDENCE S01 Interview/rights work materials

Nathan Deville: Wait Till He Turns | Oct 6–8 | DONE / LOCAL WORK

Worked through the first full hunter feature using Nathan's account, his father's guidance and the central "wait till he turns" moment. Revised chronology and prose, and prepared a branded HTML story layout with imagery.

Why it matters. There is a concrete story to demonstrate the intended brand direction. Final factual review and publication rights remain outstanding.

EVIDENCE S02 Branded HTML story and supporting imagery



Actual local story-page opening. Internal demonstration only; the interview facts and image/publication rights require final clearance.

PROPOSED STORY PATHWAY

Invitation → conversation → recorded interview with consent → factual review by the participant → selected photographs and permissions → owner editorial approval → story page on the approved website → follow-up with the contributor.

08 One documentary pilot, as a separate decision

A filmed documentary is worth considering because the first story has already shown the emotional and editorial direction. But the website launch must not depend on buying cameras, arranging a crew, securing a property, or producing a feature film.

WHAT IS COMPLETED

- The “Every Hunt Has a Story” editorial direction has been developed.
- Hunter interview questions and preliminary rights material exist.
- A complete first-story treatment and a visual HTML reading experience exist.
- Outreach has produced contacts and organizations that may be willing to participate.

WHAT IS ONLY PROPOSED

- Choose one subject, potentially Nathan, after fact-checking and written permissions.
- Prepare one treatment, practical shot list, filming-location agreement and capped cost estimate.
- Use truthful interviews and accurately labeled reenactments where they add value.
- Make a separate owner decision on whether a pilot should be filmed at all.
- Evaluate the completed pilot before deciding to make additional films.

The guardrail. No fabricated original footage, no filming without location and subject consent, and no invented claims about the people or their hunts. An approved written story can launch before any film exists.

Keep the distinction visible in the presentation

Already exists	Not yet authorized
Interview forms, written-story treatment, HTML page.	Final signed story/photo/publication releases.
Research and interested external contacts.	Filming schedule, access to land, crew and budget.
A proposed documentary approach.	Production, distribution or an episode series.

09 The launch sequence from this meeting forward

These are proposed working windows, not promised dates. Each step begins only when its dependencies are satisfied. Product and website work can run in parallel, while low-risk conversations continue without sending the unfinished storefront.

Window / gate	Products	Website	Relationships and story
At the owner review	Choose initial five designs and the products they represent.	Open the deployed GitHub Pages website; approve or mark edits.	Approve reply approach, story sample and contact priorities.
Next 3–5 working days	Resolve catalog decisions; confirm provider and sample facts.	Apply owner edits to the deployed review site and Horizon source.	Organize individual replies; arrange permitted conversations.
Next 5–10 working days	Stage approved catalog changes; verify checkout/policies.	Test existing unpublished Shopify theme on desktop/mobile; apply approved fixes.	Complete fact-check and permissions for first written story.
When checks pass	Final saleable assortment and shipping proof.	Owner approves the tested Shopify theme and rollback method.	Send verified destination to interested contacts; release only approved content.
After launch	Track products, returns, fulfillment problems and edits.	Fix live issues and monitor links and analytics.	Follow through on relationships; separately decide on pilot film.

THE LAUNCH GATE CAN BE STATED IN ONE SENTENCE

We will send people to the public site when the products shown are real and approved, the important pages work, checkout and fulfillment have been verified, and Kraig and Lori have expressly approved the site they are about to put in front of those people.

10 Owner decisions to leave the meeting with

01 Initial assortment

Decision needed: Approve five design families and specific launch garments, or return an edited selection. | Owner: Kraig + Lori

02 Product disposition

Decision needed: Confirm who will make keep / move / repair / review-for-merge / retire choices. | Owner: Kraig + Lori

03 Samples and fulfillment

Decision needed: Assign access to actual provider records, physical samples, shipping and refund decisions. | Owner: Kraig + Lori

04 Website review

Decision needed: Open the deployed GitHub Pages site; approve the direction or request changes to the actual pages. | Owner: Kraig + Lori

05 Draft testing

Decision needed: Authorize acceptance testing of the existing unpublished Shopify theme and agree on the scope of any test orders. | Owner: Kraig + Lori

06 Public publication

Decision needed: Reserve final go-live approval until the acceptance checklist is complete. | Owner: Kraig + Lori

07 Outreach

Decision needed: Approve the response protocol and decide which conversations to prioritize. | Owner: Kraig + Lori

08 Hunter story

Decision needed: Approve factual and rights-review process for Nathan before any public use. | Owner: Kraig + Lori

09 Documentary pilot

Decision needed: Approve research/treatment only, fund a capped film pilot, or defer filming. | Owner: Kraig + Lori

Responsibility framework

Kraig and Lori	Craig	External / other
Choose products, approve wording/design, business terms and spending.	Prepare options, document issues, build local revisions, organize change queue.	Confirm printing, fulfillment costs, sample quality and order handoff.
Approve website candidate, live-store change and public content use.	Test agreed draft, implement only approved changes and preserve rollback.	Hunters/guardians/landowners approve story, image and location rights.
Choose priority relationships and media limits.	Coordinate replies, interviews and owner updates.	Contacts decide whether to participate and on what terms.

11 Supporting proof and review order

The files and links below are the project records supporting the completed work. I can open the deployed website, the product decision interface, the audit, the story presentation, and the relevant email threads during our review.

ID	Underlying dated evidence	Use in the meeting
P01	Whitetail_Syndicate_Current_Site_Audit-1.html	Show original catalog and customer experience.
P02	Whitetail_Syndicate_Site_Audit_and_Local_Build.pdf	Show the issues and limits of the October 3 tests.
P03	Whitetail_Syndicate_Original_Store_Products.html and Verified_Product_Sources.zip	Show real product references for artwork review.
P04	Whitetail_Syndicate_Product_Control_2026-10-06.zip	Show actual catalog snapshot, source, app and exports.
P05	Whitetail_Syndicate_Kraig_Product_Review.html	Open the owner review and walk one product.
W01	whitetail-syndicate-horizon.zip; Horizon_Theme_Updated.zip	Compare original and revised local theme archives.
W02	Whitetail_Syndicate_Site_Audit_and_Local_Build.pdf	Explain source changes and tests.
W03	Horizon_Preview_Updated-4.zip and local HTML preview files	Show revisions and final candidate for approval.
W04	craigcoda.github.io/whitetail-syndicate-horizon/ ; GitHub main and gh-pages branches	Open deployed website; inspect main theme and review-page source.
O01	Whitetail_Outreach_Full_Record_2026-10-07.json and sent-mail records	Show dated invitations and outreach scope.
O02	Whitetail_Outreach_Update_2026-10-07_Late.md	Show replies, referrals and status at archived checkpoint.
O03	Whitetail_Responses_and_Call_Plan_for_Kraig_2026-10-07.md	Review proposed call handling, not approved interviews.
S01	Interview questionnaire and release draft records	Review factual interview and consent process.
S02	Wait_Till_He_Turns_branded(1).html	Demonstrate the first actual branded story page.

BEFORE PUBLISHING THE STOREFRONT

The GitHub review site presents the work, and the Horizon theme is already installed in Shopify as unpublished. We will check the staged theme, approved products, customer messaging, signup forms, and commerce processes before requesting authorization to publish it. Contributor stories will be fact-checked and cleared before public use.